

# Reading into Writing



THE LONDON SCHOOL  
OF ECONOMICS AND  
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■



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# Assessment



- At the end of the course, you will have a 'Reading into Writing' assessment (Paper B).
- You will be given extracts from three texts and will have to use the texts to write a response to an essay question (approximately 600 words)
- You will have 90 minutes to complete Paper B. You should spend approximately 30 minutes reading and 60 minutes writing.
- Each week, you will practice and receive feedback.

This assessment (Paper B: Reading into Writing) will contribute to your marks for:

- a) Reading (60 out of 90 marks – the other 30 come from the assignment)
- b) Writing (40 out of 90 marks – the other 50 marks come from:
  - Paper A: Listening into Writing (10 marks)
  - The Assignment (40 marks)

# Marking criteria for reading



This focuses on:

- Text use
- Synthesis
- Selection
- Paraphrasing

# Marking criteria for reading



Papers awarded the highest marks will:

- Make excellent use of the texts to support argument / points.
- Be highly successful at adapting the content of texts to suit the purpose of writing.
- Be highly successfully at identifying common themes and links within and across the multiple texts.
- Demonstrate excellent quotation, paraphrasing, summarising skills

# Marking criteria for writing



This focuses on:

- Task fulfilment
- Structure
- Language Style & Range
- Language Accuracy

# Marking criteria for writing



Papers awarded the highest marks will:

- Fulfil all task requirements and present an excellent response to the essay question.
- Sequence information and ideas very logically and effectively with very clear progression, an extensive range of cohesive devices and highly effective paragraphing.
- Use a wide range of stylistically appropriate grammar and vocabulary to convey precise meanings flexibly and fluently.
- Have the majority of sentences error free; any errors which do occur will be minor and not impede communication or create difficulty for the reader.

# Marking criteria



You can see the full marking criteria on Moodle





# Reading into Writing



- Each week you will have practice.
- This week you will receive the question and text extracts in advance. We will give you some feedback but not an indicative mark.
- In weeks 2-5, you will not receive the question or text extracts in advance. We will give you feedback and an indicative mark.

# Week One: Question



This week, you will have to write a response to this question:

*Last year, 3.96 billion people used social media, which is more than half the world's population. Is this cause for concern?*

Discuss the question in a group.

- How might you answer the question?
- How could you structure your answer?

# Week Three: Texts



You will be given texts adapted from three sources:

1. Esteban Ortiz-Ospina (2019) - “Are Facebook and other social media platforms bad for our well-being?” Published online at OurWorldInData.org. Retrieved from: 'https://ourworldindata.org/social-media-wellbeing' [Online Resource]
2. Kross, E., Verduyn, P., Sheppes, G., Costello, C. K., Jonides, J., & Ybarra, O. (2021). Social media and well-being: Pitfalls, progress, and next steps. *Trends in cognitive sciences*, 25(1), 55-66.
3. Lee, A. Y., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). Social media mindsets: A new approach to understanding social media use and psychological well-being. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1)

How should you reference these texts in your essay?

# Week Three: Texts



1. Esteban Ortiz-Ospina (2019) - “Are Facebook and other social media platforms bad for our well-being?”  
Published online at OurWorldInData.org.  
Retrieved from:  
'<https://ourworldindata.org/social-media-wellbeing>' [Online Resource]
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Ortiz-Ospina (2019) argues...  
OR  
(Ortiz-Ospina, 2019)

Kross et al (2021) argue...  
OR  
(Kross et al, 2021)

Lee and Hancock (2024)  
argue...  
OR  
(Lee & Hancock, 2024)

# Summarising, paraphrasing and quoting...



- We will be discussing summarising, paraphrasing and quoting in your 'Academic Writing & Assignment' classes next week.
- We will also be discussing how to avoid plagiarism, how to synthesise texts and how to be critical/analytical.
- So, this week, do your best but don't worry too much. The focus this week is more on the criteria for 'writing' than the criteria for 'reading'.

# Secondary referencing



- One thing to be aware of is secondary referencing
- A secondary reference is when you refer to someone cited within another source, i.e. you have not read the original work.
- Ideally, you should always try and read the original source so that you can review the work first-hand.
- If you are not able to, it is acceptable to reference it as a secondary reference, following the format below.

(Haidt, 2022, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024)

# Secondary referencing



You did not read this text



(Haidt, 2022, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024)



You read this text

# Secondary referencing



Imagine you have read this article:

Lee, A. Y., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). Social media mindsets: A new approach to understanding social media use and psychological well-being. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1)

And you want to refer to research done by Beyens (below)

*When considering the influence of social media use on affective well-being, for example, Beyens et al. (2021) found that engaging with social media improved well-being for 26% of adolescents, harmed well-being in another 28%, and did not influence the well-being of 45%.*

How would you write a secondary reference?



# Secondary referencing



You would write the secondary reference as below:

Beyens et al (2021, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024) claim...  
**integral/narrative reference**

OR

.... (Beyens et al, 2021, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024)  
**non-integral/parenthetical reference**

# Task



- Now, read the text extracts and think about how you can use them in your essay.
- Compare your thoughts with a partner.

